> Beijing sees Russia less as a counterweight to the United States than as a neighbor with whom it is important to stay on good terms. It aims to secure China's "strategic rear" and preserve geopolitical flexibility. It recognizes that the United States, not Russia, is China's truly indispensable partner… () Strategic trust remains elusive. Their partnership is an axis of convenience, driven by a pragmatic appreciation of the benefits of cooperation rather than deeper like-mindedness. Moscow worries about China's growing assertiveness in East Asia, the displacement of the Russian influence from Central Asia, and the emergence of a China-centered or G-2 world. Russia would play a subordinate role. It is also anxious about the growing asymmetry of the bilateral relationship, and the extent to which Russia now depends on China, both within Asia and in the international system more generally.

China is a dominant country in the BRICS group, and in fact, wants to become rich, powerful, democratic, civilized, and harmonious as a modern, socialist country in the twenty-first century. However, if China wants to become a dominant political leader, no other country would accept it (Toloraya 2015). Likewise, scholar Lo (2015) says that Putin is committed to replacing the Western international order. To materialize, Putin rigorously promoted the BRICS stature in world affairs (However, not a revisionist approach). Putin wants to make BRICS open fora and a cohesive body so that BRICS could directly challenge the G-8 and Bretten Woods institutions. For Putin, promoting BRICS is more critical to affirm the Russian position internationally. For Beijing, BRICS is an added group in the China list and valuable but not indispensable. China does not want to bring any serious threat to its sovereignty by challenging the United States in its present scenario. For China, the importance of BRICS is just symbolic, whereas BRICS is efficient for Russia.

The alliance of BRICS intends to stay away from becoming a military group like NATO, which is the collective West's core. NATO is based on the United States' harsh diktat, whereas the BRICS is based on several founding principles: a dialogue between equal states (Toloraya 2015). Besides economic factors, the basic idea of interaction in the BRICS group is to start heeding world peace's security and stability (ibid.). Scholars like Lo (2015) said that Russia fundamentally wants to change the international order. Still, China is quite complacent with a US-led world order because